

FARM HARVEST BOOKING BOARD

Business Report

Case Study No. 61 | AgriBusiness – Buyer Coordination

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FPO Members	220
Typical Weekly Aggregation	18 tonnes of vegetables
Planning Window	2–4 weeks in advance
Core Stakeholders	Farmers • FPO • Buyers
Proposed Solution	Advance harvest booking and buyer-matching board

1. Executive Summary

The Farm Harvest Booking Board addresses a planning gap between farmers, the FPO and buyers. Farmers can declare expected crop quantity and harvest windows 2–4 weeks ahead. The FPO verifies and aggregates this information, while buyers enter procurement requirements. The system supports crop, quantity and date matching, booking confirmation and fulfilment.

The proposed solution is intended to provide early visibility, reduce last-minute procurement problems and make selling and procurement more predictable.

2. Problem Statement & Opportunity

An FPO often receives buyer enquiries after harvest has already been committed elsewhere. Farmers and the FPO have limited visibility of expected quantity and harvest dates, while buyers face uncertain availability and last-minute sourcing.

Problem Statement: The FPO needs a reliable information flow that captures expected harvest quantities and windows before harvest so that supply can be coordinated with buyer demand.

Opportunity Statement: Create a shared advance-booking information system that gives farmers and the FPO early visibility of expected harvest while giving buyers reliable information to plan procurement in advance.

3. Customer Segments & Value Proposition

Stakeholder	Needs	Pain Points	Benefits
Farmers	Simple harvest declaration; buyer visibility; predictable selling	Buyers found too late; uncertain sales; distress-selling risk	Planned selling; better demand visibility; organised sales
FPO / Coordinator	Reliable forecasts; collection planning; aggregation	Late enquiries; difficult supply-demand coordination	Organised aggregation; improved procurement planning
Buyers	Dependable quantity; reliable dates; advance visibility	Last-minute sourcing; uncertain availability	Advance procurement planning; reliable purchasing

Value Proposition: Give farmers and the FPO early visibility of expected harvest while giving buyers reliable information to plan procurement in advance.

4. End-to-End Customer Journey

Step	Actor	Activity
1	Farmer	Registers
2	Farmer	Declares crop, expected quantity and harvest window
3	FPO	Verifies and aggregates harvest information
4	Buyer	Enters procurement requirement
5	System	Matches crop + quantity + date
6	Buyer	Requests / expresses interest
7	FPO	Confirms booking
8	FPO	Collects harvest
9	FPO	Quality check and consolidation
10	Buyer	Receives delivery
11	System	Completes booking

5. Supply Chain / Operating Flow

FARMERS → HARVEST FORECAST → FPO COLLECTION / COORDINATION → SORTING & QUALITY CHECK → AGGREGATION → BUYER MATCHING → LOGISTICS → BUYER / FINAL DELIVERY

Supply Chain Responsibilities:

- Farmers: Declare crop, quantity and harvest window.
- FPO Collection / Coordination: Verify forecasts and schedule collection.
- Sorting & Quality Check: Apply basic quality standards.
- Aggregation: Consolidate lots by crop.
- Buyer Matching: Match crop, quantity and date with buyer demand.
- Logistics: Arrange planned transport and delivery.
- Buyer / Final Delivery: Receive the confirmed order.

Information Flow: Farmer Forecast → FPO Dashboard → Buyer Requirement → Match → Confirmation → Fulfilment.

6. Business Model Canvas

Key Partners	FPO coordinators; farmers; buyers; logistics providers
Key Activities	Harvest forecasting; verification; matching; booking; collection; quality coordination
Value Proposition	Early visibility, organised aggregation, advance procurement planning and reliable fulfilment
Customer Relationships	FPO-supported onboarding; simple booking; reminders; coordination
Channels	Booking board/system; FPO coordinators; WhatsApp communication
Customer Segments	Farmers; FPO/coordinators; buyers
Key Resources	Booking information system; farmer network; FPO coordination; buyer demand data
Cost Structure	Platform development/maintenance; coordination; training/communication; logistics and quality coordination
Revenue Streams	Small booking/transaction fee; buyer subscription or premium access; optional logistics coordination fee

7. Financial / Performance Logic

18 tonnes/week = 18,000 kg/week. Average planning assumption per member = $18,000 \div 220 = 81.8$ kg/member/week. This is an average planning assumption and not actual production for every farmer.

The case does not provide prices or fees, so a monetary revenue calculation is not supported. Proposed revenue streams are a small booking/transaction fee, buyer subscription or premium access, and an optional logistics coordination fee.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs): % of harvest declared 2–4 weeks ahead; % of declared volume matched with buyers; booking confirmation rate; fulfilment rate; farmer participation rate.

8. SWOT Analysis

Strengths	Better harvest visibility; stronger farmer-buyer coordination; advance planning; existing FPO network.
Weaknesses	Initial farmer participation may be low; harvest forecasts may be inaccurate.
Opportunities	Organised procurement; stronger buyer relationships; digital agriculture adoption; expansion to more crops and FPOs.
Threats	Weather and crop failure; price fluctuations; quality variation; logistics disruption.

9. Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Inaccurate forecasts	Periodic forecast updates
Low participation	Training, WhatsApp reminders and simple booking process
Buyer cancellations	Confirmation rules and backup buyers
Weather / crop failure	Flexible quantity updates and alternate suppliers
Quality inconsistency	Basic standards and FPO inspection
Delivery delays	Planned logistics and collection schedules

10. Go-to-Market & 90-Day Pilot

Recommended approach: Pilot → Validate → Improve → Scale. Start with selected farmers and buyers, track participation, forecast accuracy, matching and fulfilment, improve the process using feedback, and then expand to a wider FPO network. Adoption can be supported by FPO coordinators and WhatsApp communication.

Period	Actions
Days 1–30	Select pilot farmers; onboard buyers; set up booking process; train FPO coordinators.
Days 31–60	Start advance harvest declarations; match supply with buyer demand; track booking and fulfilment data.
Days 61–90	Evaluate results; improve matching; expand participation; prepare scale-up plan.

Pilot Success Criteria

Proposed pilot targets: ≥60% of pilot farmers submit harvest forecasts and ≥70% of declared volume is matched with buyer demand. The pilot should confirm bookings before harvest, reduce last-minute procurement issues and improve farmer participation.

11. Conclusion

The Farm Harvest Booking Board provides a practical information-flow solution for advance harvest planning. Connecting farmer forecasts, FPO verification and aggregation, buyer requirements, matching, confirmation and fulfilment can improve visibility across the three stakeholder groups. The 90-day pilot should validate participation, matching and fulfilment before wider scale-up.